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lives in high saline waters because of its high osmoregulatory capacity.

13.7.1 Fish culture

Characteristics of cultivable fishes

The special characteristic features of cultivable fishes are:

i. Fishes should have high growth rate in short period for culture.
ii. They should accept supplementary diet.
iii. They should be hardy enough to resist some common diseases and infection of parasites.
iv. Fishes proposed for polyculture should be able to live together without interfering or attacking other fishes.
v. They should have high conversion efficiency so that they can effectively utilize the food.

Types of cultivable fish

Cultivable fish are of 3 types(Figure 13. 9).

a. Indigenous or native fresh water fishes (Major carps, *Catla*, *Labeo*, *Clarias*)
b. Salt water fishes acclimatized for fresh water (*Chanos*, Mullet).
c. Exotic fishes or imported from other counties (Common carps)

Among these, major carps have proved to be best suited for culture in India, because the carps

1. Feed on zooplanktons and phytoplanktons, decaying weeds, debris and other aquatic plants.
2. They can survive in turbid water with slightly higher temperature
3. Can tolerate O_2 variations in water.
4. Can be transported from one place to other easily.
5. They are highly nutritive and palatable.

External factors affecting fish culture

The factors that affect fish culture are temperature, light rain, water, flood, water current, turbidity of water, pH hardness, salinity and dissolved O_2. Light and temperature also play an important role in fish breeding.

Catla

Mullet

Common carps

Figure 13. 9 Different types of freshwater cultivable fishes